Topic 3 — Governors-General & Viceroys

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Governors-General and Their Reforms | Governors-General and Associated Wars | British Governors | Governors-General | Viceroys | Works and Reforms | Regulating Act (रेगुलेटिंग एक्ट) 1773 (रेगुलेटिंग एक्ट) | Pitt's India Act 1784 (पिट्स इंडिया एक्ट) | Charter Acts 1793 / 1813 / 1833 / 1853 | Government of India Act 1858 | Indian Councils Acts 1861 / 1892 / 1909 | Montagu-Chelmsford (मांटेग्यू-चेम्सफोर्ड) Reforms / Government of India Act 1919 | Government of India Act 1935 | Lord Dalhousie (डलहौज़ी) | Doctrine of Lapse (विलुप्ति सिद्धांत) | Lord Curzon (कर्ज़न) | Lord Macaulay | Warren Hastings (वारेन) | Cornwallis (कॉर्नवालिस) | Wellesley (वेलेज़ली) | William Bentinck (बेंटिंक) | Canning | Ripon (रिपन) | Dufferin (डफ़रिन) | Elgin | Minto | Hardinge | Linlithgow (लिनलिथगो) | Wavell | Mountbatten

Sources baked in: Spectrum, NCERT Themes III, UPPCS Prelims PYQs 2018–2025, Ghatnachakra GG/Viceroy bank **Weight:** ★★★ — GG/Viceroy ↔ reform matching, associated wars, Act ↔ provision matching, title traps (GG vs Viceroy) **Last verified:** September 2026 gap audit — war CCR tags filled on GG cards; Queen's Proclamation card; land-revenue ownership pointed to Topic 4; Extra Drill gaps flagged (no invented mega banks) **Current Affairs:** N/A (historical) **Ownership:** Full Permanent Settlement (स्थायी बंदोबस्त) / Ryotwari (रैयतवाड़ी) / Mahalwari (महलवाड़ी) compare and colonial economy sit in Topic 4. This chapter keeps **GG/Viceroy (वायसराय) tags**, Acts, and war–ruler matching.

3.0 Phase framework — the one picture to hold first

Do not memorise 30-odd names as a flat list. The office itself changed **shape** four times. Fix the shape, then hang each ruler on the right hook.

Phase	Years	What changed	First holder
Company Governors of Bengal	to 1773	Governor of Fort William / Bengal Presidency (प्रेसीडेंसी) under Company charter; no all-India legal standing	Clive (1758–60, 1765–67)
Governor-General of Bengal	**1773–1833**	Regulating Act creates the post with a 4-member Council; Bombay and Madras stayed formally separate but subordinate on war, peace and treaties	**Warren Hastings**
Governor-General of India	**1833–1858**	Charter Act of 1833 extends the office over all British India; Company keeps administering but stops trading altogether	**William Bentinck**
Viceroy	**1858–1947**	GOI Act 1858 ends Company rule after the 1857 Revolt; the Crown rules directly; the same person now holds both titles, Viceroy (Crown's representative) and Governor-General (head of administration)	**Canning**

Phase	Years	What changed	First holder
Late Viceroys / transfer of power	**1936–1947**	Provincial autonomy, war-time politics, and constitutional missions run down to Partition and Independence	Linlithgow → Wavell → **Mountbatten**

British policy towards Indian states (PSC ladder)

#	Years	Policy name
1	**1740–65**	Company's struggle for equality with Indian powers
2	**1765–1813**	**Ring Fence / Security Cell** (buffer logic; Hastings and Wellesley)
3	**1813–57**	**Subordinate Isolation**
4	**1858–1935**	**Subordinate Union**
5	**1935–47**	**Equal Federation** (federation idea under GOI Act 1935)

- The **richest single trap** across the whole topic is mixing up these four labels. Hastings is never a Viceroy. Canning is never a mere "GG of Bengal." Bentinck is the hinge year, **1833**.
- Acts did two different jobs. Some **created or reshaped the office** (1773, 1784, 1833, 1858). Others **reshaped who could legislate or vote** (1861, 1892, 1909, 1919, 1935). Keep these two families apart in your head.
- The **Governor-General of India remained in place after 1858 too** — the same man was simply also called Viceroy. The title never disappeared; it merged with "Viceroy."

> **Logic:** If a question asks for the "first Governor-General," check whether it means of **Bengal** (Hastings, 1773) or of **India** (Bentinck, 1833). The first **Viceroy** was **Canning (1858)**. Ring Fence ≠ Subsidiary Alliance ≠ Doctrine of Lapse.

3.1 Office of Governor-General and Viceroy — quick office map

- The **Regulating Act of 1773** created the first **Governor-General of Bengal**, **Warren Hastings**, with a four-member Council. The **Supreme Court at Calcutta** began in **1774**.
- **Pitt's India Act, 1784** set up a **Board of Control** for politics and left the **Court of Directors** with commerce.
- The **Charter Act of 1833** created the **Governor-General of India**. The first holder was **William Bentinck**. The Company ceased to trade.
- The **Government of India Act, 1858** ended Company rule. The GG also became **Viceroy**. A **Secretary of State** and a Council of India were created in London. The first Viceroy was **Canning**.
- The **Indian Councils Act, 1861** introduced the **portfolio / departmental** system.
- The **Indian Independence Act, 1947** named the last Viceroy as **Mountbatten**.
- The last Governor-General of India was **C. Rajagopalachari (1948–50)**.

> **Logic:** Hastings is the first **Governor-General** of Bengal, not the first Viceroy. **Canning** is the first Viceroy (**1858**). Every Act named above gets its own full teaching card below — this section is only the map.

3.2 Company Governors of Bengal (before 1773)

These names belong mainly to Topic 2's Bengal-conquest story. Here they are tagged only as the **office predecessors** of the Governor-General.

- **Robert Clive** governed Bengal in **1758–60** and again in **1765–67**. His second term produced the **Treaty of Allahabad (इलाहाबाद की संधि) (1765)** and the start of **Dual Government**.
- On the **civilian** side he banned gifts to officials and private trade by Company servants. On the **military** side he ended the double **batta** (extra allowance); from **1766** the allowance was kept only for troops serving **outside** Bengal and Bihar.
- He is often called the **founder of the British Empire in India** after Plassey (प्लासी) and Diwani (दीवानी), but he was **never** Governor-General of Bengal — that title begins with Hastings under the Regulating Act.
- **Verelst** and **Cartier** governed Bengal while Dual Government continued, including the **Bengal Famine of 1770**.
- None of these men held the legal title **"Governor-General."** That title starts only with the **Regulating Act of 1773**.

> **Logic:** Dual Government was **enforced by Clive (1765)** and **abolished by Warren Hastings (1772)**. Full Plassey–Buxar (बक्सर)–Diwani detail sits in Topic 2.

3.3 Regulating Act, 1773

Identity: First parliamentary statute regulating the East India Company in India | **Creates:** Governor-General of Bengal

British Parliament's first serious attempt to regulate Company rule, passed after the Company nearly went bankrupt despite ruling rich Bengal.

- It created the post of **Governor-General of Bengal** with a **four-member Executive Council**. **Warren Hastings** was the first holder.
- This is **not** the Governor-General of India — that all-India title comes only with the **Charter Act of 1833**.
- Bombay and Madras were made **subordinate to Bengal** in war, peace and treaties with Indian powers.
- A **Supreme Court** was set up at **Calcutta in 1774**. The first Chief Justice was **Sir Elijah Impey**.
- Clash between the Supreme Court and the Governor-General-in-Council was later eased by the **Amending Act / Act of Settlement, 1781**.

- The Company's **Court of Directors** (24 members) had to report revenue, civil and military matters to the British government.
- Company servants were barred from **private trade** and from taking **presents or bribes**, though the ban was widely broken in practice.

> **Logic:** Regulating Act **creates the Bengal office**. Pitt's India Act (**1784**) reorganises **London control**. Do not call Hastings the first GG of India.

3.4 Warren Hastings (1772–1785)

First Governor-General of Bengal (Regulating Act 1773). Governor of Bengal from **1772**.

- On the Court of Directors' order he ended **Dual Government in 1772**. The Company took direct Diwani charge; deputy Diwans **Muhammad Reza Khan** and **Raja (राजा) Shitab Rai (राई)** were dismissed.
- He moved the **state treasury from Murshidabad to Calcutta**.
- He started hierarchical **Diwani and Faujdari** courts; Cornwallis later made the system more rigid.
- He and Wellesley are linked with the **Ring Fence / Security Cell** policy — protect Company territory by buffering neighbours (notably Awadh) rather than open annexation everywhere.
- The **Asiatic Society of Bengal** was founded on **15 January 1784**. **Sir William Jones** was founder-president. Hastings **declined** the chair.
- Impeachment proceedings ran in Britain from **1788 to 1795** (charges pressed by **Edmund Burke**); he was **acquitted** in light of his service.
- His rival in Council was **Philip Francis**.
- He did **not** invent the Subsidiary Alliance.
- Established **Sadar Diwani Adalat** and **Sadar Nizamat Adalat** (appellate courts) at Calcutta; auctioned the right to collect land revenue to the highest bidder (quinquennial settlement 1772); codified Hindu and Muslim laws, leading to N.B. Halhed's English translation of the Sanskrit code as ***A Code of Gentoo Laws*** (1776); wrote the introduction to the first English translation of the *Bhagavad Gita* by **Charles Wilkins** (1784).

Wars and clashes under Hastings (Cause → Course → Result)

Rohilla War, 1774

- **Cause:** The Rohillas of Rohilkhand threatened Awadh; **Shuja-ud-Daula** (शुजाउद्दौला) asked for Company troops under Hastings's Ring Fence logic.
- **Course:** Company forces helped Awadh crush the Rohillas; **Hafiz Rahmat Khan** was killed.
- **Result:** Rohilkhand came under Awadh's control, but the war later fed Hastings's impeachment charges over cruelty and presents.

First Anglo-Maratha (आंग्ल-मराठा) War (to Salbai, 1782)

- **Cause:** Succession (उत्तराधिकार क्रम) intrigue at Poona and the Treaty of Surat–Purandhar tangle pulled the Company into Maratha politics.

- **Course:** Fighting swung between Bombay and Bengal theatres; neither side won a clean knockout.
- **Result:** The **Treaty of Salbai (सालबाई की संधि), 1782** restored a long peace and left the Company stronger in western India without full Maratha annexation.

Banaras / Chait Singh, 1781

- **Cause:** Hastings pressed the Raja of Banaras, **Chait Singh**, for extra tribute and troops.
- **Course:** Revolt flared at Banaras; Hastings fled briefly to **Chunar**.
- **Result:** Chait Singh was deposed; Banaras stayed a UP-facing Hastings tag and another impeachment charge.

> **Logic:** Warren ≠ **Lord Hastings** (1813–23). Jones founded the Asiatic Society, not Hastings. Ring Fence is Hastings–Wellesley; Subsidiary Alliance as a finished tool is Wellesley.
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> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Asiatic Society of Bengal (1784):** - **Founder:** Founded on **15 January 1784** at Calcutta by **Sir William Jones** (Orientalist scholar and Supreme Court judge). - **Governor-General:** Established during the tenure of **Warren Hastings**, who actively encouraged the society and patronized Charles Wilkins' English translation of the *Bhagavad Gita*, but modestly declined the offer of Presidentship in favour of Sir William Jones.
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> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Warren Hastings & Asiatic Society (UPPCS A/R Spine):** - **Assertion (A):** The Asiatic Society of Bengal was established during Warren Hastings' period and he declined the Presidentship in favour of Sir William Jones. *(True)* - **Reason (R):** Hastings was an erudite scholar with deep appreciation for Oriental learning (Persian, Arabic, Sanskrit). *(True, but R is not the complete causal explanation of A; Hastings declined out of administrative propriety and recognition of Jones's supreme linguistic authority).*

3.5 Pitt's India Act, 1784

Named for British Prime Minister **William Pitt the Younger**. It fixed the problem the Regulating Act had left open: **who really controls Company policy from London.**

- It created a **Board of Control** (commonly remembered as **six** Crown-appointed commissioners) to oversee the Company's **political and military** affairs.
- The **Court of Directors** kept charge of **commercial** business but had to send its political correspondence through the Board first. This dual setup is often called **dual control from London** — do not confuse it with Clive's **Dual Government in Bengal (1765)**.
- The Governor-General's Council was **reduced from four members to three**, giving the Governor-General a stronger relative (सापेक्ष) voice.
- Bombay and Madras were placed **fully under the control** of the Governor-General and Council in Calcutta.
- Company territories in India were, for the first time, officially termed **"British possessions in India."**
- The Board's expenses were later charged more clearly to Indian revenues under the quiet renewals that followed.

> **Logic:** Pitt's Act = **Board of Control + Directors**. Regulating Act = **creates GG of Bengal**. Dual control (London) ≠ Dual Government (Bengal).

3.6 Lord Cornwallis (1786–1793; short second term 1805)

Permanent Settlement, 1793 (GG tag only)

- He introduced the **Permanent Settlement of 1793** in **Bengal, Bihar and Orissa**. Land revenue was fixed **in perpetuity** with the zamindar (ज़मींदार) treated as proprietor.
- The plan was shaped with **John Shore's** revenue work; Cornwallis enacted it. Zamindars who failed to pay risked losing the estate under the harsh payment rules (often remembered as the **sunset** rule).
- Cultivators stayed **tenants**; they did **not** get ownership under this settlement. The Company gained a **stable cash demand**.
- **Madras** was **not** Permanent Settlement country — **Ryotwari** (Munro (मुनरो)) and other systems dominate there. **Mahalwari** (महलवाड़ी) belongs mainly to North India.
- Full compare of Permanent Settlement / Ryotwari / Mahalwari (shares, revision, peasant classes) lives in the British Administration and Economy chapter — keep only the Cornwallis tag here.

Judicial, police and service reforms

- The **Cornwallis Code of 1793** collected his judicial reforms and rested on **separation of powers**: revenue work was split from judicial work.
- In **1787** the District Collector briefly held Diwani-judge powers and some Faujdari powers. In **1790–92** Indian-staffed district Faujdari courts were replaced by **four Circuit Courts** (three for Bengal, one for Bihar) under European judges, with Indian kazis and muftis assisting.
- Under the Code, the Collector lost judicial and police powers and kept **taxation only**. District Judges took civil, criminal and police work in a new hierarchy.
- He is credited with founding the **covenanted Indian Civil Service** (Public Services) on European lines; higher covenanted posts stayed **Europeans only**.
- In **1793** he separated landlords from police duties, set up thanas roughly every twenty to thirty square miles, and appointed the **Daroga** under the Magistrate — often remembered as the local face of Company authority ("Aura and Authority of Company Bahadur").
- He returned for a short second term from **30 July to 5 October 1805** and died at **Ghazipur (Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश))**; his tomb is still there.

Third Anglo-Mysore War (Cause → Course → Result)

- **Cause:** Tipu attacked Travancore, a Company ally; Cornwallis formed a triple front with the Nizam (निजाम) and the Marathas.
- **Course:** Allied armies pushed Tipu back; Seringapatam came under pressure.
- **Result:** The **Treaty of Seringapatam, 1792** forced Tipu to cede about half his territory and pay a heavy indemnity. Cornwallis personally led this war.

> **Logic:** Permanent Settlement = **Cornwallis** (not Bentinck). Ryotwari = **Munro**. Sati abolition = **Bentinck, 1829**. Tomb at Ghazipur is a UP-facing fact.

3.7 Charter Act, 1793

Identity: Quiet 20-year renewal between Pitt's dual control (1784) and the trade break of 1813

- This Act **renewed the Company's charter for another 20 years**. The Company's **trade monopoly continued**.
- It made almost no structural (संरचनात्मक) change to the Indian office, so it is easy to under-read — but Match List stems still use it as a chronology anchor.
- The **Board of Control's** expenses were charged to **Indian revenue**.
- The Governor-General's power to **override his Council** in special cases was strengthened.
- The **Commander-in-Chief** was **not** automatically a Council member unless specially appointed.
- Cornwallis's separation of revenue from judicial work (the Cornwallis Code) continued alongside this renewal.

> **Logic:** 1793 = **quiet renewal + monopoly continues**. **1813** cuts the India trade monopoly. **1833** ends all Company trade and creates GG of India.

3.8 Sir John Shore (1793–1798)

- Shore continued Cornwallis's policy of **non-intervention**: avoid new wars with Indian states whenever possible.
- He is remembered for the **Vizier Ali affair at Banaras (1797–98)**, a succession dispute in Awadh that flared up near the end of his term.
- He extended the **Permanent Settlement** (स्थायी बंदोबस्त) principle further and kept the civil service reforms of Cornwallis running.
- His caution frustrated the Company's directors, who wanted a more forward policy (फॉरवर्ड). Wellesley replaced him in **1798**.

> **Logic:** Shore is the **calm before Wellesley**. Between Cornwallis and Wellesley, **Shore** followed a policy of **non-intervention**, not Cornwallis himself.

3.9 Lord Wellesley (वेलेज़ली) (1798–1805)

- He gave **Subsidiary Alliance** its finished shape from **1798**. He did **not** invent the idea: **Dupleix** (डुप्ले) had first lent European troops to an Indian ruler for fixed payment, and the Company used an early form with **Awadh in 1765**.

- The **first state to accept Wellesley's evolved version** was the **Nizam of Hyderabad (1798; renewed 1800)**. Sequence after that: **Mysore (1799)**, **Tanjore (तंजावुर) (1799)**, **Awadh (1801)**, **Peshwa (पेशवा) (Dec 1802)**, **Bhonsle of Berar (1803)**, **Sindhia (1804)**, then Rajput (राजपूत) states such as Jodhpur, Jaipur, Machheri, Bundi and Bharatpur; **Holkar** came later (**1818**).
- The ruler kept internal administration but lost control of war, peace and other Europeans. He paid a **subsidy**, accepted a **British Resident**, and could not employ non-British Europeans. The aim was British **paramountcy** and a standing army (सेना) at the ally's cost — **not** a fixed commercial income for the Company as the main object.
- He arrived when British fear of **Napoleon** was high; subsidiary alliances helped keep Indian states from French contact and keep the British flag firm in India.
- Wellesley was **recalled in 1805** because the wars cost too much.

Wars under Wellesley (Cause → Course → Result)

Fourth Anglo-Mysore War, 1799

- **Cause:** Tipu's French contacts and refusal of a full subsidiary settlement alarmed Wellesley in the Napoleonic years.
- **Course:** Company armies stormed Seringapatam; **Tipu** was killed in **1799**.
- **Result:** Mysore went under Subsidiary Alliance with a restored **Wodeyar** child ruler; Tipu's sons were detained.

Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803–05

- **Cause:** The **Treaty of Bassein (बेसिन की संधि) (31 December 1802)** pulled **Peshwa Bajirao II** into subsidiary alliance — the **first Maratha chief** under Wellesley's finished system — and provoked other Maratha houses.
- **Course:** About **6,000** British troops restored the Peshwa at Poona against land/revenue worth about **₹26 lakh** a year. **Arthur Wellesley** won at **Assaye**; campaigns also hit Bhonsle and Sindhia.
- **Result:** Maratha power was broken in the north and west; British paramountcy advanced, but war costs helped trigger Wellesley's recall.

> **Logic:** Wellesley = Subsidiary Alliance, **not** Doctrine of Lapse. First Wellesley ally = **Hyderabad**; first Maratha = **Bajirao II (Bassein)**; earliest Company-style deal often cited = **Awadh 1765**.
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> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Early 19th-Century Chronological Spine (UPPCS 2024):** - 1. Death of Nana Fadnavis: **1800 CE** (the *"Maratha Machiavelli"*) - 2. Recall of Lord Wellesley: **1805 CE** - 3. Vellore Mutiny: **July 1806 CE** (under Governor Sir George Barlow) - 4. Anglo-Nepalese War: **1814–1816 CE** (under Lord Hastings; concluded by Treaty of Sugauli)

3.10 Barlow and Minto I (1805–1813) — the bridge years

Two lesser-named rulers cover the gap between Wellesley's recall and Lord Hastings' arrival. They are worth only a short bridge card.

- **George Barlow** served as acting Governor-General for a short spell in **1805** after Cornwallis died in office. He kept to non-intervention and cut costs after Wellesley's expensive wars. The **Vellore Mutiny (1806)** broke out in this bridge period (often tagged to Barlow's Madras/Company regime).
- **Lord Minto I (1807–1813)** dealt with the fallout of the **Vellore Mutiny (1806)** and signed the **Treaty of Amritsar (अमृतसर) (1809)** with Ranjit Singh (रणजीत सिंह), fixing the Sutlej (सतलुज) as the Sikh empire's southern limit.
- The **Charter Act of 1813** was passed as his term was ending, right at the hand-over to Lord Hastings.

> **Logic:** These two names rarely anchor a full question on their own; they matter mainly as **chronology filler** between Wellesley (recalled 1805) and Lord Hastings (from 1813).

3.11 Lord Hastings, Earl of Moira (1813–1823) — not Warren

- He was the **Earl of Moira**. He is **not** Warren Hastings.
- **Charles Metcalfe** negotiated **subordinate alliances of 1817–18** with princely states of **Rajputana** on Hastings' behalf.
- The **Ryotwari settlement** was formalised in Madras under **Thomas Munro** (Governor of Madras **1820–27**) during this broader era — full Ryotwari teaching sits in the Administration and Economy chapter.
- The **Charter Act of 1813**, which ended the Company's India trade monopoly, was enacted right as his term began.

Wars under Lord Hastings (Cause → Course → Result)

Anglo-Nepal War, 1814–16

- **Cause:** Gorkha expansion into the Terai (तराई) and hill tracts collided with Company frontier claims.
- **Course:** Early British setbacks gave way to a hard mountain campaign.
- **Result:** The **Treaty of Sugauli** (signed **1815**, ratified **1816**) fixed Nepal's frontiers and brought hill posts such as Kumaon (कुमाऊँ)–Garhwal (गढ़वाल) into the British orbit.

Pindari (पिंडारी) campaign and Third Anglo-Maratha War, 1817–18

- **Cause:** Pindari raids into Company territory and the last Maratha challenge to paramountcy.
- **Course:** Hastings ran a coordinated campaign against Pindaris and Maratha houses together.
- **Result:** The **Peshwa title was abolished**; Peshwa territories went into the Bombay Presidency; British **paramountcy** across central India was established.

> **Logic:** If a question pairs Hastings with Nepal or Sugauli, it is **Lord Hastings**, not Warren. Third Maratha War ≠ Cornwallis.

3.12 Charter Act, 1813

- The Company's **trade monopoly in India was ended**. Other British merchants could now trade freely with India, though the Company kept its monopoly over **tea** and trade with **China**.
- The Company's **political control and territories** were renewed for another 20 years.
- For the first time, the state accepted responsibility for Indian education: **₹1 lakh a year** was earmarked for this purpose.
- **Christian missionaries** were allowed to preach and settle in India, a right the Company had earlier restricted.
- Local governments were given some power to **tax for local purposes**.

> **Logic:** 1813 kills the **India** trade monopoly only, keeping tea/China. **1833** finishes the job and ends **all** Company trade.

3.13 Lord Amherst (1823–1828)

- **John Adam** briefly acted as Governor-General in **1823** before Amherst arrived. Adam is remembered mainly for tightening **press licensing** — the restrictions Metcalfe later removed.
- Amherst also oversaw the long **Siege of Bharatpur (1825–26)**, where the British finally broke the fortress that had resisted them since Lord Lake's failed attempt in 1805.

First Anglo-Burmese War (Cause → Course → Result)

- **Cause:** Burmese expansion under the Konbaung kings into Assam–Manipur frontiers and clashes with Company outposts.
- **Course:** A costly jungle and river war; Burmese commander **Maha Bandula** was killed at Danubyu in **1825**.
- **Result:** The **Treaty of Yandabo, 1826** gave the Company **Assam, Manipur, Arakan and Tenasserim**.

> **Logic:** First Burma War is **Amherst's**, not Dalhousie's. Basic date fact = **Yandabo 1826**.

3.14 Lord William Bentinck (1828–1835)

- **Sati was abolished in 1829** (Regulation XVII) after the campaign of **Raja Rammohan Roy**; the rule was extended to Madras and Bombay in **1830**.
- He also moved against **female infanticide** and other social evils.
- **Thuggee** was suppressed under **Captain (later Major) William Sleeman**; about **1,562** thugs were arrested between **1826 and 1835**, and organised thuggee was largely broken by about **1837**.
- On the Court of Directors' wish he preferred **non-interference** in princely states when possible (for example Jaipur, Jodhpur, Bundi, Kota, Bhopal), but he took over **Mysore in 1831**, **Cachar in 1832**, and **Coorg (Kurg) in 1834** for extreme mismanagement; **Jaintia** (जयंतिया) followed in **1835**.

- His seven-year rule largely dropped the older war-and-annexation drive in favour of administrative and social reform.
- He was the first to hold the title **Governor-General of India** under the **Charter Act of 1833**.
- He accepted **Macaulay's Minute (1835)**. **Calcutta Medical College** was founded in **1835**.
- He also extended the **Ryotwari** and **Mahalwari** revenue settlements and eased some restrictions on the press.
- Slave-export from Bengal had been stopped by a **1789** order; later slave laws (**1811**, **1823**) and the **1833** Charter pressed for abolition; **Act V of 1843** under Ellenborough made slavery illegal in most of India, and the **IPC 1860** treated it as a crime.

> **Logic:** Bentinck = Sati **and** the title switch to "Governor-General of India" in **1833**. Permanent Settlement is **Cornwallis**. Slavery abolition as a finished Act = **Ellenborough 1843**, not Bentinck alone.

3.15 Charter Act, 1833

The single most important Act between 1773 and 1858 for **office structure**.

- The **Governor-General of Bengal became the Governor-General of India**. The first holder of this all-India title was **William Bentinck**.
- The Company **stopped trading altogether**, even in tea and China trade. It became a purely **administrative body**, ruling India on behalf of the Crown.
- **Legislative power was centralised** in the Governor-General-in-Council. Bombay and Madras presidencies lost their own law-making power.
- A new **Law Member** was added to the Governor-General's Council as a fourth, non-voting member. **Lord Macaulay** was the first Law Member.
- A **Law Commission** was set up to codify Indian law, which eventually produced the **Indian Penal Code**.
- Section 87 of the Act stated that no Indian subject should be barred from any office on grounds of religion, birth or colour, but this promise was **not implemented** in practice.

> **Logic:** 1833 = **GG of India created + all Company trade ends + Law Member added**. Keep these three together as one key fact.

3.16 Lord Macaulay

- He was **Law Member** of Bentinck's Council, the first person to hold that new post created by the Charter Act of 1833. He was **not** a Governor-General.
- His **Minute on Indian Education (2 February 1835)** favoured **English** as the medium of higher education and the idea of **downward filtration**.

- He drafted the **Indian Penal Code**, which was enacted in **1860**, under the Law Commission set up by the 1833 Act.
- **Wood's Despatch of 1854** (Dalhousie's time) is the later mass-education plan. It is **not** Macaulay's Minute.

> **Logic:** Macaulay **1835** ≠ Wood **1854** ≠ Hunter **1882** (Ripon).
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Chronology of British Education Landmarks:** - 1. Wood's Despatch: **1854 CE** (*"Magna Carta of English Education in India"*) - 2. Hunter Education Commission: **1882 CE** (under Lord Ripon, primary & secondary education) - 3. Sadler Commission: **1917 CE** (Calcutta University Commission) - 4. Sargent Plan of Education: **1944 CE**

3.17 Lord Metcalfe (1835–1836) — "Liberator of the Press"

- Metcalfe served as **acting Governor-General** for about a year, between Bentinck's departure and Auckland's arrival.
- He is remembered chiefly for **removing the restrictions on the press** that Governor-General Adams had imposed in 1823, earning him the title **"Liberator of the Indian Press."**
- Before this, he had served as **Resident at Delhi** and as an agent to the Governor-General in Rajputana, dealing directly with Mughal (मुग़ल) court politics.
- His term was too short for major legislative reform; his single durable legacy is **press freedom**.

> **Logic:** The Governor-General who **freed the press** in the 1830s was **Metcalfe**, not Bentinck.

3.18 Lord Auckland (1836–1842)

- Education policy continued along Macaulay's English-medium line during his tenure, but this is a minor footnote next to the Afghan disaster.
- Auckland was recalled after the Afghan collapse, and **Ellenborough** replaced him to manage the fallout.

First Anglo-Afghan War, 1839–42 (Cause → Course → Result)

- **Cause:** Fear of Russian influence on **Dost Muhammad** pushed Auckland into a forward Afghan adventure.
- **Course:** The British installed **Shah Shuja** at Kabul; occupation turned sour; the winter **1841–42** retreat from Kabul destroyed almost the whole column.
- **Result:** A military and political disaster; Auckland was recalled; later Viceroys treated Afghan occupation with caution until Lytton's Proud Reserve revived a forward line.

> **Logic:** First Afghan War = **Auckland**, not Dalhousie or Ellenborough. The disaster, not the

> annexation, is the key fact.

3.19 Lord Ellenborough (1842–1844)

- **Act V of 1843** abolished **slavery** in British India under him.
- The Afghan line of **Masterly Inactivity** began in his time and ran through to **Northbrook**; it is usually credited to **John Lawrence** (लॉरेंस), who practised it most fully. The phrase is linked to an article by **J. W. S. Wiley**.
- He is also remembered for the controversial **"Gates of Somnath (सोमनाथ)"** episode, where he brought back gates from Afghanistan claiming they were the temple's original looted gates — a claim historians dispute.
- His autocratic style and costly gestures irritated the Court of Directors, who **recalled him in 1844**, one of the few Governors-General removed directly by the Directors rather than by the Crown.

Sindh annexation, 1843 (Cause → Course → Result)

- **Cause:** Company fear of an open Indus (सिंधु)–Afghan corridor and disputes with the **Talpur Amirs** of Sindh.
- **Course:** Field commander **Sir Charles Napier** defeated the Amirs at **Miani** and **Dabo**.
- **Result:** Sindh was annexed in **August 1843** under Ellenborough — not under Dalhousie.

> **Logic:** Sindh is **1843**, under **Ellenborough**, not Dalhousie. Slavery Act = Ellenborough. Masterly Inactivity ≠ Wellesley or Canning.

3.20 Lord Hardinge I (1844–1848)

- He banned **human sacrifice** and worked against **female infanticide** among tribal (आदिवासी) groups such as the Khonds.
- He encouraged English education and gave a hiring preference to English-educated Indians for some government posts.
- He handed over to **Dalhousie** in **1848**, just before the Second Sikh War.

First Anglo-Sikh (आंग्ल-सिख) War, 1845–46 (Cause → Course → Result)

- **Cause:** After Ranjit Singh's death, Khalsa (खालसा) army politics and British troop moves on the Sutlej frontier hardened into war.
- **Course:** Hard-fought battles such as Mudki, Ferozeshah, Aliwal and Sobraon decided the campaign.
- **Result:** The **Treaty of Lahore, 1846** cut Sikh power, placed a British Resident at Lahore, and set up the later annexation of Punjab under Dalhousie.

> **Logic:** Hardinge **I** = First Sikh War, 1845–46. Do not confuse with **Hardinge II** (Viceroy 1910–16,

> Delhi Durbar).

3.21 Lord Dalhousie (1848–1856)

- He used the **Doctrine of Lapse**. Adopted (अंगीकृत) heirs were **not recognised**.
- Lapse chronology: **Satara (1848)** first; **Jaitpur and Sambalpur (1849)**; **Baghat (1850)**; **Udaipur (उदयपुर) (1852)**; **Jhansi (झांसी) (1854)**; **Nagpur (1854)**.
- **Awadh in February 1856** was taken for **misgovernance**, not Lapse. The Nawab was **Wajid Ali Shah** (वाजिद अली शाह). In **1854 James Outram** replaced **W. H. Sleeman** as Resident; Outram's report that Awadh's administration was corrupt and the people miserable became the annexation brief.
- He also took hill tracts of **Sikkim** (including Darjeeling-side areas) on a pretext of mistreatment of British subjects.
- His real name was **James Andrew Broun-Ramsay** (Earl of Dalhousie).
- **Wood's Despatch** belongs to **1854**.
- The **first passenger railway** ran from **Bombay (Boribunder) to Thane in 1853**, started by the **Great Indian Peninsula Railway**. Motives were mainly to move **raw (रॉ) materials to ports** and to move the **army** quickly against revolt.
- He set up a separate **Public Works Department** (about **1854**) and spent heavily on roads, canals and other works; earlier public works sat under the Military Board.
- The Widow Remarriage Act of **1856** was drafted in his time and passed as Canning took over.
- Later railway expansion peaked around **1900** under **Curzon**, but the **start** of passenger rail is Dalhousie.
- Introduced the **Non-Regulation system** of centralized administrative control in newly acquired territories (Punjab, Lower Burma / Pegu); raised Gurkha regiments.
- Recommended the **Thomsonian system of vernacular education** for the North-Western Provinces (1853); founded the first Engineering College at Roorkee (**Thomason College of Civil Engineering**).
- Laid the basis of the modern postal system (**Post Office Act, 1854**) with uniform half-anna postage stamps; started the electric telegraph service (Calcutta to Agra); worked on the Grand Trunk Road and developed the harbours of Karachi, Bombay, and Calcutta.

Wars and annexations under Dalhousie (Cause → Course → Result)

Second Anglo-Sikh War and Punjab, 1848–49

- **Cause:** Resentment after Lahore settlement, Multan revolt, and Khalsa army politics broke the fragile peace.
- **Course:** Battles such as Chillianwala and Gujarat decided the war.
- **Result: Punjab was annexed in 1849**; the Sikh kingdom ended as an independent power.

Second Anglo-Burmese War, 1852

- **Cause:** Trade and diplomatic disputes at Rangoon after Yandabo's unsettled aftermath.
- **Course:** A short coastal campaign took Lower Burma.

- **Result: Pegu / Lower Burma** was annexed; full Burma annexation waited for Dufferin's Third War in **1885**.

> **Logic:** Dalhousie = Lapse + railways + PWD. Awadh = **misrule**, not Lapse. He did **not** accept Lakshmibai (लक्ष्मीबाई)'s adopted son. First Burma = Amherst; Second = Dalhousie; Third = Dufferin.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Governor-General & Reform Matching (UPPCS 2025 Spine):** - **Lord Cornwallis:** Permanent Settlement of Bengal (1793) - **Lord William Bentinck:** Prohibition of Sati (Regulation XVII of 1829) - **Lord Dalhousie:** Doctrine of Lapse (1848 onwards) - **Lord Curzon:** Partition of Bengal (1905)
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — 1857 Leadership & Doctrine of Lapse (UPPCS 2024 Spine):** - **Statement 1:** Babu Kunwar Singh, Zamindar of Jagdishpur (Arrah, Bihar), led the armed rebellion against the British in 1857. *(True)* - **Statement 2:** Lord Dalhousie recognised the adopted son of Rani Lakshmibai as heir. *(False — Dalhousie rejected adopted son Damodar Rao under the Doctrine of Lapse and annexed Jhansi in 1854).*

3.22 Charter Act, 1853

Identity: Last Charter Act | First serious legislative redesign | Opens ICS to competition

- For the first time, the Governor-General's **legislative and executive functions were separated**. Six new legislative councillors were added, forming a small **Indian (Central) Legislative Council** distinct from the executive.
- Limited **local / Indian representation** began in that legislative wing — still nomination-heavy, but a step beyond pure executive law-making.
- The **Law Member** became a **full** member of the Governor-General's Executive Council (earlier, under 1833, the post had been weaker in voting (गणपूर्ति) terms).
- Recruitment to the **civil services** was opened to **competitive examination**, following the **Macaulay Committee**. This ended patronage nomination. Papers long remained in **London**, so Indian entry stayed hard in practice.
- The **Court of Directors was reduced from 24 to 18** members, with six nominated directly by the Crown.
- Unlike earlier Charters, this one set **no fixed 20-year renewal** — Company rule was left deliberately open until **1858**.

> **Logic: 1833** promised equality of office in spirit (Section 87) and created GG of India. **1853** is the Act of **open ICS competition** and the first proto-legislature. **1858** ends Company rule.

3.23 Lord Canning (1856–1862)

Last GG of Company + first Viceroy (from 1858).

- He suppressed the **1857 Revolt**. He was called **"Clemency Canning."**
- With the efforts of **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar (विद्यासागर)**, the **Hindu Widow Remarriage Act, 1856** was passed; Section **XV** legalised widow remarriage and the children of such marriages. Later propagators included **Dhondo Keshav Karve** (widow ashram at Poona, **1899**) and **Vishnu Shastri**.
- The **Government of India Act 1858** ended Company rule. The **Queen's Proclamation** was read by Canning at an **Allahabad Durbar on 1 November 1858**. It put India under the Crown, abandoned annexation by conquest/Lapse as policy, and restored the right of princes to **adopt heirs**.
- The **Indian Councils Act 1861** introduced the **portfolio / departmental** system.
- The universities of **Calcutta, Bombay and Madras** were founded in **1857**.
- European troops staged the **White Mutiny in 1859**.
- The **Indian Penal Code**, drafted under the 1833 Act's Law Commission, was finally enacted in **1860** (and treated slavery as a crime).
- **Alexander (सिकंदर) Cunningham** was appointed Archaeological Surveyor in **1861** in this era (ASI later expanded; Curzon centralised it).

> **Logic:** First **Viceroy** = Canning, not Hastings or Bentinck. Widow Remarriage Act year = **1856** under Canning (drafted across the Dalhousie–Canning hand-over). Victoria as Empress / Kaiser-i-Hind = **1877 Durbar (Lytton)**, not 1858.

3.24 Government of India Act, 1858

Passed directly in response to the **1857 Revolt**, this Act is the true hinge of the whole topic.

- **Company rule ended.** India came under the **direct rule of the British Crown**.
- The **Board of Control** and the **Court of Directors** were both abolished.
- A new **Secretary of State for India**, a member of the British Cabinet, took charge of Indian affairs, advised by a **15-member Council of India** in London.
- The **Governor-General also became the Viceroy** — the Crown's direct representative in India. The first person to hold both titles together was **Canning**.
- The **Secretary of State** was given power to **supervise all administration** in India through the Viceroy.

Queen's Proclamation, 1 November 1858

- The Proclamation was read by **Canning** at an **Allahabad Durbar on 1 November 1858** — the UP-facing transfer-of-power moment.
- It announced that India had passed from the **Company to the Crown**.
- It promised non-interference in religion, equal treatment of subjects under law, and an end to annexation by conquest or **Doctrine of Lapse** as standing policy.
- Princes regained the right to **adopt heirs**. Paramountcy continued, but the open Lapse drive of Dalhousie's years was publicly dropped.
- Do **not** confuse this with Victoria's title as **Empress of India (Kaiser-i-Hind)**, proclaimed at Lytton's **Delhi Durbar of 1877**.

> **Logic:** 1858 changes **who is in charge** (Crown, not Company). It does **not** by itself create the portfolio system — that is the **1861** Act, a separate and later reform. Queen's Proclamation place = **Allahabad** (इलाहाबाद).
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Portfolio System Legalisation (UPPCS 2021 Spine):** - **Indian Councils Act, 1861:** Introduced by Lord Canning; legally substituted the 'portfolio' or departmental system for collective corporate governance in the Viceroy's Executive Council, laying the institutional foundation of modern cabinet government in India.

3.25 Indian Councils Act, 1861

Identity: Portfolio system Act | First limited Indian nomination to councils | Viceroy: Canning

- **Canning** had already begun departmental portfolios in practice around **1859**. The **1861 Act gave the portfolio / departmental system legal force**, so each Executive Council member handled a named department instead of deciding everything corporately.
- It restored **legislative powers to Bombay and Madras**, which the **1833** centralisation had taken away.
- For the first time a few **non-official Indians** could be **nominated** to legislative councils. In **1862** Canning nominated the **Raja of Banaras**, the **Maharaja (महाराज) of Patiala**, and **Sir Dinkar Rao**.
- New legislative councils followed for **Bengal (1862)**, later the **North-Western Provinces (1886)** and **Punjab (1897)**.
- The Viceroy could issue **ordinances** in an emergency, valid for up to **six months**.
- Indians entered law-making only by **nomination**. There was **no election** and **no responsible government**.

What it did not do

- It did **not** end Company rule — that is **GOI Act 1858**.
- It did **not** create communal / separate electorates — that is **1909**.
- It did **not** introduce the indirect-election principle — that is **1892**.

> **Logic: 1858 = Crown + Viceroy. 1861 = portfolio + nomination. 1892 = budget discussion + indirect election. 1909 = Muslim separate electorates.**

3.26 Lord Elgin I (1862–1863)

- Elgin I served barely eighteen months before dying of a heart attack at **Dharamshala in November 1863**.
- His short tenure saw continued frontier friction, including the **Wahabi movement's activity** on the North-West Frontier.
- Because his term was so brief, no major legislative reform is attached to his name.

> **Logic:** Elgin I is remembered mainly for **dying in office at Dharamshala**, not for any reform. Do not confuse with **Elgin II** (1894–99, famine and plague years).

3.27 Sir John Lawrence (1864–1869) — Masterly Inactivity

- His guiding frontier policy was **"Masterly Inactivity"**: after the disaster of the First Afghan War, he chose to watch the frontier carefully but avoid costly occupation of Afghan territory.
- The policy line began under **Ellenborough** and ran to **Northbrook**, but Lawrence is the name usually attached because he got the fullest chance to practise and refine it. The phrase is linked to **J. W. S. Wiley**.
- **High Courts** were established at Calcutta, Bombay and Madras in **1865**.
- The **Indian Forest Department** was set up in **1864** to manage forest resources systematically.
- He also oversaw the **Bhutan War (1864–65)**, settled by the **Treaty of Sinchula (1865)**, under which Britain gained the Duars.

> **Logic:** Masterly Inactivity = **Lawrence**. Its opposite, the more forward **"Proud Reserve,"** belongs to **Lytton**. Do not tag Masterly Inactivity to Wellesley, Canning or Mayo.

3.28 Lord Mayo (1869–1872)

- The **first all-India census** attempt belongs to **1872** under him; the first **regular** decennial census ran in **1881** under **Ripon**.
- He began **financial decentralisation** (**Mayo's Resolution, 1870**): provinces gained charge of certain services (education, medical, roads) and could raise local taxes to balance budgets — the first clear split of central and provincial finance.
- He founded **Mayo College at Ajmer (अजमेर)**, meant for the education of Indian princes.
- He was **assassinated in 1872** by a convict, **Sher Ali Afridi**, while inspecting the Cellular Jail area on the **Andaman (अंडमान) Islands** — the only Viceroy murdered while in office.
- Established the **Statistical Survey of India** (directed by W.W. Hunter); created the Department of Agriculture and Commerce; introduced State Railways.

> **Logic:** Mayo = **1872 census start + financial decentralisation + Andaman assassination**. Regular census 1881 = Ripon.

3.29 Lord Northbrook (1872–1876)

- He handled the **Bengal Famine of 1873–74**, whose relief effort was generally praised, unlike the failures under Lytton a few years later.

- He suppressed the **Kuka movement** in Punjab in 1872.
- He **resigned in 1876** after disagreeing with London over a more aggressive forward policy on Afghanistan.
- The state visit of the **Prince of Wales** to India, though planned in his time, actually took place in late 1875–76, right at the end of his tenure.

> **Logic:** Northbrook's famine relief is the **positive contrast** to Lytton's later Great Famine failure. Keep the two apart if a question compares famine handling.

3.30 Lord Lytton (1876–1880)

- The **Delhi Durbar of 1 January 1877** proclaimed Victoria as **Empress of India (Kaiser-i-Hind)** under the **Royal Titles Act, 1876**.
- He passed the **Vernacular Press Act in 1878**, also called the **Gagging / Silencing Act**, to curb criticism in Indian-language papers (S. N. Banerjee (बनर्जी) called it "lightning from the sky").
- He also passed the **Arms Act in 1878**, making it a crime for most Indians to carry arms without a licence (Europeans largely exempt).
- The **Great Famine** belongs to **1876–78**; the **Strachey Commission** and later Famine Codes grew from this crisis, and the **Famine Commission of 1880** followed — full famine teaching sits in the Administration and Economy chapter.
- Lowered the maximum age limit for the Statutory Civil Service examination from 21 to 19 years (1878–79); pursued free trade, abolishing import duties on 29 British manufactured goods (accelerating drain of wealth during severe famine).

Second Anglo-Afghan War, 1878–80 (Cause → Course → Result)

- **Cause:** Lytton's forward **"Proud Reserve"** policy replaced Lawrence's Masterly Inactivity after Russian moves toward Afghanistan.
- **Course:** British forces invaded; Kabul politics swung violently; the campaign was costly and unpopular at home.
- **Result:** A new Amir accepted British control of Afghan foreign policy; Lytton's Afghan line became the classic contrast to Lawrence's caution.

> **Logic:** Press Act and Arms Act = **Lytton**; Ripon **repealed** the Press Act. Second Afghan War = Lytton, **not** First Afghan (Auckland). Ilbert Bill is **Ripon**, not Lytton.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — 19th-Century Chronological Spine (UPPCS 2025 Matrix):** - 1. Annexation of Awadh: **February 1856 CE** (by Dalhousie on Outram's report of maladministration) - 2. Indigo Revolt in Bengal: **1859–1860 CE** (Digambar & Bishnu Biswas) - 3. Second Anglo-Afghan War: **1878–1880 CE** (under Lord Lytton) - 4. Ilbert Bill Controversy: **1883 CE** (under Lord Ripon)

3.31 Lord Ripon (1880–1884)

- He is called the **Father of Local Self-Government** because of the **Resolution of 18 May 1882** (municipalities and rural local boards).
- He **repealed the Vernacular Press Act**, which Lytton had passed in 1878.
- The **Ilbert Bill of 1883** (presented by Law Member **C. P. Ilbert** on **2 February 1883**) would have allowed Indian judges to try Europeans in criminal cases. White opposition forced a compromise.
- The **Hunter Commission (1882)** reviewed education.
- The **First Factory Act, 1881** banned employment of children **under 7**, limited children **7–12** to **9 hours** a day with **4 holidays a month**, and covered factories of a set size. The **Second Factory Act, 1891** (Lansdowne) added weekly holidays and further rules for women and children.
- The first **regular** all-India census ran in **1881** under him (the **1872** attempt was Mayo's).
- His government implemented the **Famine Code**, drawn up on the recommendations of the 1880 Famine Commission set up after Lytton's failures.

> **Logic:** Ilbert Bill and Father of Local Self-Government = **Ripon**, not Curzon or Lytton. Factory Act 1881 ≠ wage-fixing or trade-union Act.

3.32 Lord Dufferin (1884–1888)

- The **Indian National Congress** was founded in **1885** (Hume) during his tenure.
- He ridiculed Congress as a **"microscopic minority."** Do not confuse him with Curzon, Minto or Lansdowne.
- The **Bengal Tenancy Act of 1885** gave tenants some legal protection against landlords — a land-revenue aftershock taught fully in the Administration and Economy chapter.

Third Anglo-Burmese War, 1885 (Cause → Course → Result)

- **Cause:** Trade disputes, French influence fears, and unfinished British control after Lower Burma's annexation.
- **Course:** A short campaign deposed King **Thibaw**.
- **Result: Upper Burma** was annexed and Burma became a province of British India.

> **Logic:** "Microscopic minority" = **Dufferin**, not Curzon. Third Burma War completes annexation after Amherst (First) and Dalhousie (Second).
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Viceroy Dufferin's Stance on Congress:** - In 1887–1888, Viceroy **Lord Dufferin** publicly mocked the newly formed Indian National Congress at the St. Andrew's Day dinner in Calcutta, ridiculing it as representing only a ***"microscopic minority"*** of the Indian population.

3.33 Lord Lansdowne (1888–1894)

- The **Age of Consent Act, 1891** was passed in his time, raising the age of consent for marriage consummation to 12, following Behramji Malabari (मालाबारी)'s campaign.
- The **Indian Councils Act, 1892** belongs to his tenure (full card below).
- The **Factory Act of 1891** further regulated working hours for women and children.
- The **Durand Line**, the border between British India and Afghanistan, was demarcated in **1893**.

> **Logic:** Age of Consent Act 1891 and Councils Act 1892 both belong to **Lansdowne**, not Ripon.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Age of Consent Act, 1891 (UPPCS 2024 Spine):** - **Advocate:** Spearheaded by Parsi social reformer **Behramji M. Malabari**; enacted under Viceroy **Lord Lansdowne**, raising the legal age of consent for girls from 10 to 12 years. - **Opposition:** Strongly opposed by **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** and orthodox nationalists, who protested foreign legislative interference in sacred Hindu domestic customs.

3.33A Indian Councils Act, 1892

Identity: Budget-discussion Act | Indirect election without using the word “election” | **Viceroy:** Lansdowne

- Non-official seats rose in the Central and Provincial Legislative Councils, but an **official majority** remained at the Centre.
- Councils could **discuss the annual budget** and ask **questions** on matters of public interest. They still could **not** vote the executive out or reject the budget as a whole.
- An element of **indirect election** entered through **nomination on recommendation**. The statute carefully avoided the open word **“election.”**
- Central nominations drew on Provincial Legislative Councils and bodies such as the **Bengal Chamber of Commerce**.
- Provincial nominations drew on **District Boards, Municipalities, Universities, Trade Associations and Zamindars**.
- The Act still gave **no responsible government** and **no separate communal electorate** (that comes in **1909**).

> **Logic: 1861 = portfolio + nomination. 1892 = budget talk + indirect election. 1909 = Muslim separate electorates.** Do not call 1892 the start of communal electorates.

3.34 Lord Elgin II (1894–1899)

- His tenure was dominated by the **famine of 1896–97** and a severe **plague outbreak in Bombay** the same years.

- Harsh plague-control measures led to unrest; the officer **W. C. Rand** was assassinated by the **Chapekar brothers in 1897** in protest.
- Frontier tribal uprisings, including the **Tirah campaign (1897)**, also marked his term.
- He came **just before Curzon**, and is easily confused with **Elgin I** (1862–63), who instead is remembered for dying in office.

> **Logic:** Neither Elgin ordered the Partition of Bengal or the Ilbert Bill — both belong to later or earlier rulers.

3.35 Lord Curzon (1899–1905)

- Among Viceroys he had one of the **longest tenures (1899–1905, about seven years)**.
- The **Partition of Bengal** was announced for **16 October 1905**. A new province of **East Bengal and Assam** was created.
- Archaeological work had older roots (**Asiatic Society 1784**; **Alexander Cunningham** as Archaeological Surveyor from **1861**; Survey made a separate body in **1871**). Under Curzon the **ASI** was integrated and centralised (**1901**); **John Marshall** became Director-General (**appointed 1901; took charge 1902**).
- The **Ancient Monuments Preservation Act, 1904** provided for protection of monuments; Curzon allocated about **£50,000** for conservation.
- The **Indian Universities Act** also belongs to **1904**, tightening government control over universities.
- The Police Commission sat in **1902** under **Sir Andrew Frazer (Fraser)**; Universities Commission under **Sir Thomas Raleigh** in **1902** (leading to Indian Universities Act 1904). The **NWFP** was created in **1901**. The **Imperial Cadet Corps** was approved in **1901**.
- Set up Department of Commerce and Industry; passed Indian Coinage and Paper Currency Act (1899) putting India on gold standard; conceived the **Victoria Memorial** at Calcutta (foundation laid 1906, opened 1921).
- The **Calcutta Municipal Act, 1899** (Mackenzie (मैकेंज़ी) Act) reduced elected Indian strength on the Corporation.
- He pushed irrigation and resigned in **1905** after a clash with **Kitchener** over control of the army.
- The **Younghusband mission** went to **Tibet in 1904**.
- **Gopal Krishna (कृष्णा) Gokhale (गोखले)** compared Curzon's rule to that of **Aurangzeb** (औरंगजेब). Curzon also spoke of assisting Congress to a **"peaceful demise."**

> **Logic:** Partition and Ancient Monuments Act = **Curzon**. Vernacular Press Act ≠ Curzon (that is **Lytton**). "Microscopic minority" ≠ Curzon (**Dufferin**).
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Partition of Bengal & Civil Administration 1905:** - Enacted by **Lord Curzon** on **16 October 1905**; reorganized provincial boundaries to create the new Muslim-majority province of **'Eastern Bengal and Assam'** (capital at Dacca), while Western Bengal was combined with Bihar and Orissa.

3.36 Lord Minto II (1905–1910)

- He took over after Curzon. **John Morley** was Secretary of State for India. Their joint package is remembered as the **Morley–Minto Reforms**, legally the **Indian Councils Act, 1909**.
- Before the Act, the **Simla Deputation (1 October 1906)** met Minto and asked for Muslim weightage and separate representation. The **All-India Muslim League** was founded at **Dacca in December 1906**.
- Minto is often tagged **"Father of the Communal Electorate"** because **1909** gave legal force to **Muslim separate electorates**.
- **Rajendra Prasad** later called Minto the **Father of Pakistan**, because communal electorates sowed the long partition logic.
- Gandhi (गांधी)'s harsh line on the package is remembered as saying the **Morley–Minto Reforms destroyed us / destroyed everything** — a teaching tag for how nationalists read the Act.
- **S. P. Sinha** became the first Indian member of the Viceroy's Executive Council (**Law Member**) under these reforms.
- The Act enlarged councils and let members discuss the budget and ask questions, but it did **not** create responsible government or dyarchy.

> **Logic:** 1909 = separate electorates + Sinha. **Chamber of Princes** and **dyarchy** (द्वैध शासन) belong to **1919**, not Minto.

3.37 Indian Councils Act, 1909 (Morley–Minto Reforms)

Identity: Indian Councils Act, 1909 | **Viceroy:** Lord Minto II | **Secretary of State:** John Morley

Background

- After the Partition of Bengal and the rise of Extremists, the British wanted to **associate loyal Indians** with councils and to **detach Muslim opinion** from the Congress stream.
- The **Simla Deputation (1906)** and the birth of the **Muslim League (1906)** set the communal bargaining frame that entered the statute in **1909**.

Main provisions

- The **Imperial (Central) Legislative Council** was enlarged (commonly remembered rise from about **16 to about 60** members). An **official majority** was kept at the Centre.
- **Provincial Legislative Councils** were also enlarged. In some provinces a **non-official majority** became possible.
- Members could ask **questions** and **supplementary questions**, and move **resolutions on the budget**. They still could **not** vote the executive out, and the budget as a whole was not controlled by the council.
- **Separate electorates for Muslims** (**communal representation**) were introduced: only Muslim voters elected Muslim candidates in reserved seats. This is the first legal communal electorate.

- Prelims often ask what **1909 provided**: answer **communal representation / separate electorates — not** dyarchy, federation, or provincial autonomy.
- Separate representation was also arranged for bodies such as **Presidency Corporations, Chambers of Commerce, Universities and Zamindars**.
- Indians entered the **Viceroy's Executive Council**. The first Indian appointee was **Satyendra Prasad Sinha** (Law).

What it did not do

- It did **not** introduce **dyarchy**.
- It did **not** create a **bicameral** centre.
- It did **not** create the **Chamber of Princes**.
- It did **not** promise responsible self-government in the language later used in the **Montagu Declaration (मॉण्टेग्यू) (1917)**.

Political result

- Nationalists treated it as a **divide-and-rule** device that legalised communal politics.
- Prelims traps almost always turn on **1909 = Muslim separate electorates** versus **1919 = dyarchy** versus **1932 Communal Award** (not the first Muslim separate electorate).

> **Logic:** Morley–Minto = **association without responsibility**. Montagu–Chelmsford = **limited responsibility through provincial dyarchy**.

3.38 Lord Hardinge II (1910–1916)

- At the **Delhi Durbar of 1911** (December), he hosted **George V** and **Queen Mary**. On **12 December 1911** the king announced annulment of the Partition of Bengal and the transfer of the capital from **Calcutta to Delhi**.
- The capital shift was completed in **1912** under Hardinge II. If a stem forces **1911 vs 1912**, prefer **1912** for completed transfer and **1911** for the Durbar announcement.
- Bengal was reconstituted; **Bihar and Orissa** were separated as a province (**from 1 April 1912**); Assam returned toward its earlier separate status.
- A bomb was thrown at the Viceroy's procession in **Chandni Chowk on 23 December 1912**.
- The network is linked to **Anushilan (अनुशीलन) Samiti (समिति)** and **Rash Behari Bose**.
- The **First World War** began during his tenure, in 1914.

> **Logic:** Do not confuse with **Hardinge I** (1844–48, First Sikh War). Capital shift and annulment of Partition = **Hardinge II**, not Curzon.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Delhi Conspiracy Case (1912):** - On 23 December 1912, during the state entry into the new capital of Delhi, a bomb was thrown at Viceroy **Lord Hardinge II** at Chandni

> Chowk; planned and executed by revolutionaries of the **Anushilan Samiti** led by **Rash Behari Bose** and Sachindra Nath Sanyal.

3.39 Lord Chelmsford (1916–1921)

- His tenure covers World War I's endgame in India and the first mass nationalist shock after Rowlatt–Jallianwala.
- The **Montagu Declaration** of **20 August 1917** (Secretary of State **Edwin Montagu**) announced the goal of the gradual development of **self-governing institutions** and responsible government in India. That declaration is the political preface to the **GOI Act, 1919**.
- The **Government of India Act, 1919** (Montagu–Chelmsford / "Montford" reforms) introduced **provincial dyarchy**, a **bicameral centre**, and the **Chamber of Princes**.
- The **Rowlatt Act (1919)** and **Jallianwala Bagh (13 April 1919)** fall in the same years as the reform package and poisoned Indian trust in British "self-government" promises.
- **Tagore** returned his knighthood. **C. Sankaran Nair (शंकरन नायर)** resigned from the Viceroy's Executive Council over the Punjab wrongs.
- The **Chamber of Princes** (~**120** members) was provided by the 1919 Act and formally inaugurated in **1921**.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Chamber of Princes (Narendra Mandal):** - Established under the **Government of India Act, 1919** based on the Montagu-Chelmsford Report; formally inaugurated by the Duke of Connaught at the Red Fort, Delhi on **8 February 1921**, comprising 120 princely members.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Executive Council Resignation over Jallianwala Bagh (1919):** - **Sir Chettur Sankaran Nair** resigned from his coveted post as Education Member in the Viceroy's Executive Council in July 1919 in protest against the barbaric atrocities of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre and the subsequent atrocities of martial law in Punjab.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Renunciation of Knighthood over Jallianwala Bagh (1919):** - **Rabindranath Tagore** renounced his British Knighthood in May 1919, writing to Viceroy Lord Chelmsford that *"the time has come when badges of honour make our shame glaring in the incongruous context of humiliation"*.

3.40 Government of India Act, 1919 (Montagu–Chelmsford Reforms)

Identity: GOI Act, 1919 / Montford Reforms | **Viceroy:** Lord Chelmsford | **Secretary of State:** Edwin Montagu | **In force from:** 1921

Background

- Based on the **Montagu Declaration (20 August 1917)**: gradual introduction of responsible government in India.

- Came after wartime recruitment and the Home Rule (होम रूल) agitation, and in the same political climate as **Rowlatt** (रॉलेट) and **Jallianwala** — so Indians judged the Act against those wrongs.

Structure of government

- Subjects were classified into **Central** and **Provincial** (Devolution Rules).
- **Dyarchy in the provinces** (dual rule):
- **Reserved subjects** — police, justice, land revenue, irrigation, and similar "hard" subjects — stayed with the **Governor and his Executive Councillors**, **not** responsible to the legislature.
- **Transferred subjects** — education, health, local self-government, agriculture, and similar "soft" subjects — went to **Indian ministers** responsible to the Legislative Council.
- At the **Centre** there was still **no dyarchy**. The Viceroy's Executive Council remained the real executive. The Act did provide for **more Indian members** on that Council (commonly remembered as up to **three**, besides the Commander-in-Chief).

Legislature

- The old Indian Legislative Council was replaced by a **bicameral** central legislature:
- **Council of State** (Upper House)
- **Legislative Assembly** (Lower House)
- A majority of members were chosen by **direct election**, but the franchise stayed narrow.
- Provincial legislatures were **enlarged**, with elected majorities for the first time in that form.
- Provincial budgets were separated from the central budget.

Communal and princely features

- **Separate electorates** were **extended** beyond Muslims to **Sikhs, Indian Christians, Anglo-Indians and Europeans**.
- The Act provided for a **Chamber of Princes (Narendra Mandal)** — about **120** members — inaugurated in **1921**.

Other high-yield provisions

- Created the office of **High Commissioner for India** in London.
- Provided for a **Public Service Commission** → the **Central PSC** was set up in **1926**.
- Ordered a **statutory commission after ten years** → this became the **Simon Commission (साइमन कमीशन) (1927)**.
- Local self-government became a real **transferred** subject under Indian ministers — the institutional payoff of Ripon's earlier local-self-government seed.

Limits and later link

- Dyarchy was **half-responsible government**: ministers controlled only transferred subjects; Governors kept reserved subjects and special powers.
- Congress largely criticised the Act as inadequate; Liberals and some others worked the councils.
- **1935** later ended provincial dyarchy and introduced **provincial autonomy**. Centre dyarchy under 1935 never operated. Until federation could start, large parts of central practice still rested on the

1919 frame.

> **Logic:** 1919 = **provincial dyarchy + bicameral centre + Chamber of Princes + Simon clause**. 1909 = **Muslim separate electorates** only as the headline reform. Do not swap.

3.41 Lord Reading (1921–1926)

- **Rufus Isaacs, Lord Reading**, was the **only Jewish Viceroy** of India.
- The **Non-Cooperation (असहयोग) Movement** ended after the **Chauri Chaura incident (February 1922)**; Gandhi was arrested in **March 1922**.
- The **Moplah Rebellion** in Kerala broke out in 1921, early in his term.
- The **Swaraj Party** was formed in 1923 by **C. R. Das** and **Motilal Nehru (नेहरू)** after the suspension of Non-Cooperation.
- The **Kakori Conspiracy Case (1925)** against revolutionary (क्रांतिकारी) nationalists was tried during his tenure.

> **Logic:** Reading covers the **retreat from Non-Cooperation** and the rise of the Swaraj Party. Do not confuse with Irwin's later Civil Disobedience (सविनय अवज्ञा) years.

3.42 Lord Irwin (1926–1931)

- The **Simon Commission** (साइमन कमीशन) was the statutory review ordered by the **1919 Act** after ten years. It was appointed in **1927** and arrived in India in **1928**.
- All **seven** members were British; **no Indian** sat on it. The boycott (बहिष्कार) cry was **"Simon Go Back."**
- **Lala Lajpat Rai** (लाला लाजपत राय) was injured in the Lahore lathi-charge during the protest (**1928**) and later died — a major flashpoint of the boycott years.
- The Simon Report (**1930**) urged an end to **provincial dyarchy**, more responsibility for provinces, movement toward a **federation**, and continuation of **communal electorates**. Boycott and deadlock pushed politics into the **Round Table Conferences** and then **GOI Act 1935**.
- The **Nehru Report (नेहरू रिपोर्ट) (1928)** and the **Lahore Session (पंगु सत्र) of Congress (December 1929)**, which declared **Purna Swaraj** (पूर्ण स्वराज), both fall in Irwin's term.
- The **Dandi March / Salt (लवणाध्यक्ष) Satyagraha (सत्याग्रह)** began in **1930**.
- The **First Round Table Conference (1930–31)** was held in London without Congress participation.
- The **Gandhi–Irwin Pact** (गांधी-इरविन) was signed in **March 1931**, ending Civil Disobedience for the time being and securing the release of political prisoners.

> **Logic:** Irwin = **Simon boycott + Dandi + Gandhi–Irwin Pact**. Simon is the child of the **1919** ten-year clause, not a sudden 1927 invention.

3.43 Lord Willingdon (1931–1936)

- The **Second Round Table Conference (1931)** was held with Gandhi attending in person.
- The **Communal Award (1932)**, announced by British PM MacDonald, proposed separate electorates for the "depressed classes" among others.
- The **Poona Pact (September 1932)** between Gandhi and Ambedkar (अम्बेडकर) replaced this separate electorate with joint electorates and reserved seats for depressed classes.
- The **Third Round Table Conference (1932)** followed, and its recommendations fed into the **Government of India Act, 1935**.
- **Civil Disobedience was formally called off in 1934.**

> **Logic:** The Communal Award and the Poona Pact both sit inside **Willingdon's** term, directly setting up the 1935 Act.

3.44 Government of India Act, 1935

Identity: Longest British Indian constitutional statute | Template for much of Independent India's structure | **Provincial parts in force from 1937**

Background

- Grew out of the **Simon Report (1930)**, the three **Round Table Conferences**, and the White Paper process after Civil Disobedience.
- It is the last major constitutional Act before Independence and the one whose **provincial** machinery Congress actually worked in **1937**.

Federal design (mostly on paper)

- It proposed an **All-India Federation** of British Indian provinces plus princely states.
- Accession of states was **voluntary**. Because enough princes did not join, the **federation never started**.
- At the Centre the Act wrote a form of **dyarchy**: defence, external affairs and related reserved subjects stayed with the Governor-General; other federal subjects were to go to ministers. This **centre dyarchy never operated**.
- Until federation could begin, much of the Centre still ran on the older **1919** executive and legislative frame.

Provincial autonomy (what actually worked)

- **Dyarchy in the provinces was abolished.** From **1937**, provinces got **provincial autonomy**: ministers responsible to elected legislatures for provincial subjects.
- Powers were divided into **three lists**: **Federal, Provincial and Concurrent** (commonly remembered about **59 / 54 / 36**).
- **Residuary** (अवशिष्ट) powers under the Act stayed with the **Governor-General / Viceroy**.

- Bicameral legislatures were provided in **six** provinces: **Bengal, Bombay, Madras, Bihar, Assam and the United Provinces**.
- Governors kept **special responsibilities** and **discretionary / ordinance** powers (including the Instrument of Instructions style control). So autonomy was real but **not absolute (निरपेक्ष)**.

Courts, money, services, territory

- A **Federal Court** was set up in **1937** — the forerunner path to the Supreme Court.
- The Act **provided for** a reserve bank to control currency and credit. The bank itself rests on the **RBI Act, 1934**, with operations from **1 April 1935**.
- It provided for **Federal / Provincial / Joint Public Service Commissions**.
- It **abolished the Council of India** in London and left the Secretary of State with advisers.
- It **separated Burma (1937)** and **Aden** from India.
- Franchise widened further but stayed limited. Communal representation continued and was extended after Poona Pact politics.

Political result

- In the **1937** elections Congress formed ministries in a **majority of provinces** (commonly remembered as about **seven of eleven**).
- Nehru mocked the Act as a car with **brakes but no engine** and as a **Charter of Slavery** (Lucknow (लखनऊ) Congress **1936** rejected the Act).
- The Act's **Instrument of Instructions** style guidance later fed the vocabulary of the Constitution's **Directive Principles (राज्य के नीति निदेशक तत्व) of State Policy**.
- **Lionel Curtis** is often tagged **father of dyarchy** for the **1919** scheme (dyarchy moved to the Centre on paper in **1935**, never worked).
- The League's "**Day of Deliverance**" (December 1939) celebrated Congress ministries' resignation after the war declaration — a later Linlithgow-era fact that sits on this Act's provincial stage.
- Independent India's Constitution borrowed heavily from this Act's **lists, federal court idea, and provincial structure**.

> **Logic: 1919 = provincial dyarchy. 1935 = provincial autonomy** (worked) + **federation / centre dyarchy** (paper only). Do not say the 1935 federation "started."

3.45 Lord Linlithgow (1936–1943)

Identity: Longest-serving Viceroy of the late British period | War Viceroy | August Offer / Cripps / Quit India years

Provincial autonomy years

- He oversaw the first working of **provincial autonomy** under the **GOI Act, 1935**.
- After the **1937** elections, **Congress ministries** took office in a majority of provinces.

- When Britain declared war on Germany in **September 1939**, Linlithgow announced India's involvement **without consulting** Indian leaders. Congress ministries **resigned in October–November 1939**.
- The Muslim League marked **22 December 1939** as **Day of Deliverance**.

1940 bridge

- The **Ramgarh Congress session (March 1940)** sits just before the August Offer in the standard arrange ladder.
- The **August Offer (8 August 1940)** promised dominion status (डोमिनियन) after the war, expansion of the Viceroy's Executive Council, and a post-war body to frame India's constitution — but it kept a minority / League veto flavour that Congress rejected.
- **Individual Satyagraha** began in **October 1940**. The first satyagrahi was **Vinoba Bhave**; Nehru followed. It was a limited, selected protest, not a mass CDM-style campaign.
- The League's **Lahore Resolution (March 1940)** demanding Muslim-majority "independent states" also falls in this Viceroyalty.

1942 crisis

- The **Cripps Mission (March 1942)** offered dominion status after the war, a Constituent Assembly (संविधान सभा), and a provincial opt-out clause. Congress and the League both rejected it. Gandhi's side branded it a **post-dated cheque**.
- **Quit India** (भारत छोड़ो) was launched on **8 August 1942** at Bombay with Gandhi's call of **Do or Die** (करो या मरो). The British arrested the top leadership at once; the movement went underground and faced harsh repression.
- **Subhas Chandra Bose** (सुभाष चंद्र बोस) had already formed the **Forward Bloc (फॉरवर्ड ब्लॉक) (1939)**; the INA (आज़ाद हिंद फौज) story abroad runs alongside Linlithgow's last years and into Wavell's.

Other tags

- The **Bengal Famine of 1943** began toward the end of his tenure and continued into Wavell's arrival.
- He is the usual answer for the **longest-serving** late-phase Viceroy.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Chronology of War & Nationalist Politics (1939–1942):** - 1. Resignation of Congress Ministries: **October–November 1939** (protest over India being dragged into WWII without consent) - 2. Ramgarh Congress Session: **March 1940** (presided by Maulana Abul Kalam Azad) - 3. Linlithgow's August Offer: **8 August 1940** - 4. Cripps Mission arrival: **March 1942**
>
> **Logic:** August Offer = **Linlithgow, 1940**. Cripps / Quit India = **1942**. Do not give Wavell the August Offer.

3.46 Lord Wavell (1943–1947)

Identity: Endgame Viceroy before Mountbatten | Wavell Plan / Simla | Cabinet Mission / Interim Government years

Famine and war end

- He took charge in **October 1943** while the **Bengal Famine** was still killing on a mass scale and tried to improve food administration.
- World War II ended in **1945**. Political prisoners from Quit India began to be released as talks restarted.

Wavell Plan and Simla Conference, 1945

- The **Wavell Plan (June 1945)** proposed an interim Executive Council with equal Hindu and Muslim representation (apart from the Viceroy and Commander-in-Chief) and invited Indian leaders to form it.
- The **Simla Conference (June–July 1945)** tried to implement that plan. It failed mainly because the League insisted it alone spoke for all Muslims, while Congress claimed to speak for all Indians including Muslims.
- Do not confuse **Simla 1945** with the later Cabinet Mission of **1946**.

Pressure from armed forces and missions, 1945–46

- The **INA Trials** at the Red Fort (लाल किला) (**1945–46**) created huge public sympathy for the accused officers.
- The **RIN Mutiny (February 1946)** of naval ratings at Bombay (and other centres) added military pressure on British authority.
- The **Cabinet Mission (1946)** still arrived while Wavell was Viceroy. Its plan of **16 May 1946** proposed a united India with a weak centre and provincial grouping. Congress and League accepted and rejected different parts over time.
- **Direct Action Day (16 August 1946)** followed League politics around the Cabinet Mission deadlock and produced communal massacres, especially in Calcutta.
- The **Interim Government** was formed on **2 September 1946** under Nehru. The League later joined and then obstructed from inside.

Exit

- By early 1947 London decided on a fixed withdrawal. **Mountbatten** replaced Wavell in **March 1947**.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor — Chronology of Constitutional Negotiations (1942–1946):** - 1. Cripps Mission: **March 1942** - 2. Wavell Plan: **June 1945** (broadcast on 14 June) - 3. Shimla Conference: **25 June – 14 July 1945** - 4. Cabinet Mission: **March 1946** (arrived 24 March)
>
> **Logic:** Wavell Plan ≠ Mountbatten Plan (माउंटबेटन योजना). Simla **1945** ≠ Cabinet Mission **1946**. Full mission stories sit in Topic 14; this card is the Viceroy tag + order.

3.47 Lord Mountbatten (March–August 1947) and the transfer of power

Identity: Last Viceroy of British India | Mountbatten Plan | Partition and Independence

Appointment and brief

- He became Viceroy in **March 1947**, after **Attlee's statement (20 February 1947)** fixed British withdrawal by **June 1948** and named him.
- Communal violence and Congress–League deadlock made an early, clear transfer seem necessary. Mountbatten advanced the timetable.

Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947)

- Also called the **3 June Plan**. Congress and the League accepted its broad outline.
- British India would be partitioned into two **Dominions**: **India** and **Pakistan**.
- Provinces / areas would choose through assemblies or referendum-style procedures (Punjab and Bengal to be partitioned if they opted that way; NWFP referendum; Sylhet referendum).
- Princely states would become free of paramountcy and could accede to either Dominion (or, in theory, stand aside — later integration is a post-Independence story).
- A boundary commission would draw the lines — later associated with **Sir Cyril Radcliffe**.

Indian Independence Act, 1947

- Passed by the British Parliament and received assent on **18 July 1947**.
- It gave legal force to the two Dominions, ended British paramountcy over the states, and set **15 August 1947** as the transfer date.
- Keep three 1947 dates apart: **Plan 3 June**, **Act 18 July**, **Independence 15 August**.

After 15 August

- Mountbatten stayed on as the **first Governor-General of the Dominion of India** until **June 1948**.
- **C. Rajagopalachari** then became the **last Governor-General of India** (to **26 January 1950**, when India became a Republic).
- Pakistan's first Governor-General was **Jinnah**.

> **Logic:** Last **Viceroy** = Mountbatten. Last **Governor-General of India** = **Rajagopalachari**. Do not call Mountbatten the last GG of India.

3.48 Master Fact-Locks — Governors-General, Viceroys, Reforms & Wars Matrix

Governor-General / Viceroy & Tenure	Core Reforms, Institutions & Administrative Codes	Decisive Wars, Treaties & Strategic Landmarks	Official Exam Anchors
Robert Clive (1757–60, 1765–67)	• Banned private trade and gifts to company officials (civil reform). • Ended **double bhatta (allowance)** to military officers in 1766 (granted only outside Bengal & Bihar). • Instituted **Dual Government system in Bengal** (1765–1772) dividing administration into *Diwani* (revenue/civil) and *Nizamat* (police/criminal).	• Battle of Plassey (1757). • Treaty of Allahabad (August 1765) securing imperial Diwani of Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa.	Founder of British India
Warren Hastings (1772–1785)	• Abolished Dual Government in 1772 by order of Court of Directors; dismissed deputy Diwans Muhammad Raza Khan & Raja Shitab Roy. • Transferred central treasury from Murshidabad to Calcutta. • Regulating Act 1773 created post of **Governor-General of Bengal** and 4-member council. • Founded Calcutta Madarsa (1781). • **Asiatic Society of Bengal** established on **15 January 1784** by Sir William Jones (Hastings declined Presidentship).	• **Ring-Fence Policy:** Created buffer states (guaranteed Awadh's borders at Nawab's expense) against Marathas and Afghans. • **Banaras Rebellion (1781):** Raja Chet Singh revolted; Hastings fled to Chunar Fort. • First Anglo-Maratha War (1775–82, Treaty of Salbai); Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780–84). • **Impeachment:** Impeached by Edmund Burke in Parliament (1788–1795); acquitted.	First Governor-General of Bengal

Governor-General / Viceroy & Tenure	Core Reforms, Institutions & Administrative Codes	Decisive Wars, Treaties & Strategic Landmarks	Official Exam Anchors
Lord Cornwallis (1786–93; 1805)	• **Cornwallis Code (1793):** Based on **Separation of Powers**; stripped Collectors of all judicial/magisterial authority, restricting them purely to revenue collection. • Replaced Indian district faujdari courts with **4 Circuit Courts** (3 Bengal, 1 Bihar) presided by European judges assisted by Kazis & Muftis. • Created modern **Indian Civil Service (covenanted)**. • Established police stations headed by a **Daroga** under district Magistrate (relieved Zamindars of police duties). • **Permanent Settlement (1793):** Zamindars recognized as proprietors; 10/11 share to Company, 1/11 to Zamindar; introduced Sunset Law.	• Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790–92, Treaty of Seringapatam: Tipu ceded half his kingdom). • Died at **Ghazipur (UP) on 5 October 1805**; monumental marble tomb stands in Ghazipur.	Father of Indian Civil Services
Sir John Shore (1793–1798)	Followed strict policy of non-intervention (*non-interference*) towards Indian princely states; drafted the Permanent Settlement scheme under Cornwallis.	Battle of Kharda (1795, Marathas routed Nizam while British watched).	Architect of non-intervention

Governor-General / Viceroy & Tenure	Core Reforms, Institutions & Administrative Codes	Decisive Wars, Treaties & Strategic Landmarks	Official Exam Anchors
Lord Wellesley (1798–1805)	• Codified and aggressively expanded the **Subsidiary Alliance System** (*evolved from French Dupleix's model; 1st British treaty with Awadh in 1765*). • Terms: Princely state accepted British troops, paid subsidy, stationed British Resident, dismissed non-British Europeans, surrendered foreign relations. • **Sequence of Acceptance:** 1. Hyderabad (1798 & 1800) 2. Mysore (1799) 3. Tanjore (Oct 1799) 4. Awadh (Nov 1801) 5. Peshwa (Dec 1802, Treaty of Bassein) 6. Bhonsle of Berar (Dec 1803) 7. Scindia (Feb 1804) 8. Rajput states: Jodhpur, Jaipur, Machheri, Bundi, Bharatpur. 9. Holkar (1818). • Founded **Fort William College at Calcutta** (1800) to train young civil servants.	• Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799: Tipu killed at Seringapatam; Wodeyar boy Krishnaraja III crowned under Subsidiary Alliance). • Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803–05). • Eliminated French / Napoleonic threat in India.	Great expansionist & Subsidiary Alliance
Sir George Barlow (1805–1807)	Continued non-intervention policy in Rajputana.	**Vellore Mutiny (July 1806):** Sepoys revolted over turban and religious mark restrictions; unfurled Tipu's royal tiger flag.	Vellore Mutiny

Governor-General / Viceroy & Tenure	Core Reforms, Institutions & Administrative Codes	Decisive Wars, Treaties & Strategic Landmarks	Official Exam Anchors
Lord Hastings (1813–1823)	• Supported Thomas Munro's introduction of **Ryotwari System in Madras (1820)**. • Facilitated Holt Mackenzie's **Mahalwari System** regulation (1822). • Encouraged opening of vernacular schools and colleges.	• **Anglo-Nepal War (1814–1816):** Ended with the **Treaty of Sugauli** (signed Dec 1815, ratified March 1816); Gorkhas ceded Kumaon, Garhwal, and Terai. • **Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817–1818):** Peshwaship permanently abolished (1818); Peshwa Bajirao II exiled to Bithoor (Kanpur) on pension; Maratha territories annexed to Bombay Presidency. • Complete suppression of **Pindaris** (1817–1818). • Charles Metcalfe negotiated subordinate alliances with Rajputana states.	Paramouncy & Maratha liquidation
Lord Amherst (1823–1828)	First Governor-General to visit the Mughal Emperor on equal ceremonial terms; annexed Singapore and Malacca.	• First Anglo-Burmese War (1824–1826, Treaty of Yandabo: Arakan & Tenasserim annexed). • Barrackpore Sepoy Mutiny (1824) under Binda Tiwari over overseas travel to Burma.	Treaty of Yandabo

Governor-General / Viceroy & Tenure	Core Reforms, Institutions & Administrative Codes	Decisive Wars, Treaties & Strategic Landmarks	Official Exam Anchors
Lord William Bentinck (1828–1835)	• **Abolition of Sati:** Enacted **Regulation XVII of 1829** (first in Bengal, extended to Madras & Bombay in 1830), championed by Raja Ram Mohan Roy. • **Suppression of Thuggee (1826–1835):** Appointed **Captain William Sleeman**, who arrested 1,562 thugs; eliminated ritual highway strangulation by 1837. • Banned female infanticide. • **Charter Act, 1833:** Redesignated post as **Governor-General of India**; stripped EIC of all commercial monopolies (became pure administrative body); ordered codification of laws (Macaulay Law Commission). • **Macaulay's Minute on Education (1835):** Adopted English as official language of higher education and administration. • Non-intervention in Jaipur, Jodhpur, Bundi, Kota, Bhopal; but annexed **Mysore (1831), Cachar (1832), Coorg (1834), and Jaintia (1835)** on grounds of severe misgovernance.	First Governor-General of India	Great liberal & social reformer
Charles Metcalfe (1835–1836)	Enacted Press Act of 1835 repealing Adams' 1823 Licensing Regulations; hailed universally as the ***"Liberator of the Indian Press"***.	Maintained peace across frontiers.	Liberator of Indian Press
Lord Auckland (1836–1842)	Dedicated resources to internal irrigation and Grand Trunk Road renovation.	**First Anglo-Afghan War (1839–1842):** Tripartite Treaty (1838) with Ranjit Singh and Shah Shuja; disastrous retreat from Kabul (entire British force wiped out).	Disastrous Afghan expedition
Lord Ellenborough (1842–1844)	• **Abolition of Slavery:** Passed **Act V of 1843**, declaring slavery completely illegal across British India. • Commenced the policy of ***"Masterly Inactivity"*** in Afghan affairs.	**Conquest and Annexation of Sindh (August 1843):** Completed by **Sir Charles Napier** (*"A very advantageous, useful, humane piece of rascality... Peccavi, I have Sindh"*).	Annexation of Sindh

Governor-General / Viceroy & Tenure	Core Reforms, Institutions & Administrative Codes	Decisive Wars, Treaties & Strategic Landmarks	Official Exam Anchors
Lord Hardinge I (1844–1848)	Preferred English-educated Indians in government appointments; suppressed human sacrifice (*Meriah*) among the Khonds of Odisha.	First Anglo-Sikh War (1845–1846, Treaty of Lahore: Jalandhar Doab annexed, Kashmir sold to Gulab Singh).	First Anglo-Sikh War
Lord Dalhousie (James Andrew Broun Ramsay, 1848–1856)	• **Doctrine of Lapse:** Annexed princely states whose rulers died without biological male heirs (barred adopted sons): 1. Satara (**1848** - 1st victim) 2. Jaitpur & Sambalpur (**1849**) 3. Baghat (**1850**) 4. Udaipur (**1852**) 5. Jhansi (**1854**) 6. Nagpur (**1854**) • **Annexation of Awadh (February 1856):** Annexed on grounds of chronic misgovernance (*maladministration*) based on British Resident **James Outram's report**; deposed Nawab Wajid Ali Shah. • Annexed part of Sikkim (Darjeeling) in 1850 over alleged mistreatment of two English doctors. • **Modern Infrastructure:** - **First Railway Line (1853):** Laid between Bombay and Thane (34 km) by Great Indian Peninsula Railway. - **Electric Telegraph (1853):** First line opened from Calcutta to Agra. - **Postal Act (1854):** Issued uniform half-anna postage stamps across India. - **Public Works Department (PWD):** Established separate civil department in 1854. - **Wood's Education Despatch (1854):** Outlined university system (Calcutta, Bombay, Madras founded 1857).	Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848–1849: Punjab fully annexed; Kohinoor surrendered to Queen Victoria); Second Anglo-Burmese War (1852: Lower Burma / Pegu annexed).	Modern infrastructure & Doctrine of Lapse

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Lord Canning (1856–1862)	• Enacted **Hindu Widow Remarriage Act, 1856** (Section 15 legalized remarriage and legitimacy of children), championed by Pandit Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar. • **Government of India Act, 1858:** Crown assumed direct sovereignty; EIC dissolved; Canning became **First Viceroy of India**. • Read **Queen Victoria's Proclamation at Allahabad Durbar (1 November 1858)**: Disclaimed further territorial annexation, guaranteed religious neutrality, restored right of native princes to adopt heirs. • **Indian Councils Act, 1861:** Introduced departmental portfolio system; restored legislative powers to Bombay & Madras. • **Indian High Courts Act, 1861:** Established High Courts at Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras. • Indian Penal Code (IPC) codified in 1860.	Supressed the Great Revolt of 1857 (established emergency headquarters at Allahabad); established Peel Commission for army reorganization.	Last Governor-General & First Viceroy
Sir John Lawrence (1864–1869)	• Reorganized Punjab frontier and judicial administration; created tenancy laws in Punjab and Awadh (1868). • Systematized the policy of ***"Masterly Inactivity"*** regarding Afghanistan (*refused intervention in civil wars between Dost Mohammad's sons*).	Expanded telegraphic communication between India and Europe.	Masterly Inactivity

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Lord Mayo (1869–1872)	• **Financial Decentralisation (Resolution of 1870):** First step bifurcating central and provincial finances, transferring education, sanitation, medical relief, and roads to provincial budgets. • **First Census of India (1872):** Non-synchronous census organized across provinces. • Founded Mayo College at Ajmer (1875) for princely education. • **Only Viceroy murdered in office:** Stabbed to death by convict Sher Ali Afridi during an official visit to Port Blair (Andaman Islands) on 8 February 1872.	Financial Decentralisation & 1st Census	
Lord Lytton (1876–1880)	• Nominated by Conservative PM Benjamin Disraeli; adopted aggressive ***"Forward Policy"*** towards Afghanistan. • **Royal Titles Act (1876):** Proclaimed Queen Victoria ***Kaiser-e-Hind*** (Empress of India) at the lavish First Delhi Durbar (1 January 1877) amidst catastrophic famine. • Appointed **Strachey Famine Commission (1878)** which formulated the Famine Code. • **Vernacular Press Act, 1878** (*"Gagging Act"*): Discriminatory censorship on Indian language newspapers. • **Indian Arms Act, 1878:** Made carrying arms without license a criminal offense for Indians (exempted Europeans). • Lowered maximum age limit for ICS examination from 21 to 19 years.	**Second Anglo-Afghan War (1878–1880):** Treaty of Gandamak (1879).	Reactionary Viceroy & Gagging Act

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Lord Ripon (1880–1884)	• Nominated by Liberal PM Gladstone; regarded as the most benevolent and pro-Indian Viceroy (*"Good Ripon"*). • **Local Self-Government Resolution (18 May 1882):** Formed municipal boards, taluka boards, and rural councils; celebrated as the ***"Father of Local Self-Government in India"***. • **First Decennial Synchronous Census (1881):** Began regular 10-year census cycle. • **First Factory Act (1881):** Banned factory employment of children under 7; restricted 7–12 years to 9 hours daily; guaranteed 4 monthly holidays. • **Repealed Vernacular Press Act in 1882**, restoring press liberty. • Appointed **Hunter Education Commission (1882)**. • **Ilbert Bill Controversy (1883):** Law member Sir C.P. Ilbert proposed removing racial disqualification barring Indian judges from trying Europeans; provoked ferocious Anglo-Indian agitation (*White Mutiny*); forced compromise.	Restored peace with Afghanistan (recognized Abdur Rahman); completed factory and municipal reforms.	Father of Local Self-Government
Lord Dufferin (1884–1888)	• Formation of the **Indian National Congress (December 1885)** at Bombay under A.O. Hume. • Publicly ridiculed Congress as representing only a ***"microscopic minority"***.	**Third Anglo-Burmese War (1885):** King Thibaw deposed; Upper Burma formally annexed on 1 January 1886 (**last major territorial expansion of British India**).	Annexation of Burma & INC formation
Lord Lansdowne (1888–1894)	• Enacted **Age of Consent Act, 1891** (championed by Behramji Malabari, opposed by Tilak). • Second Factory Act (1891) granted weekly holiday for all workers. • Indian Councils Act, 1892 (introduced indirect election / budget discussion).	**Durand Commission (1893):** Demarcated Durand Line between British India and Afghanistan.	Durand Line

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Lord Curzon (1899–1905)	• Longest tenure of any Viceroy (**7 years**); administrator of immense energy (*"missions, commissions, omissions"*); Gokhale compared his autocratic rule to Mughal Emperor **Aurangzeb**. • **Archaeological Survey of India (ASI):** Centralized and integrated ASI; appointed **John Marshall** Director-General in 1901 (assumed charge 1902). • **Ancient Monuments Preservation Act, 1904:** Allocated **£50,000** for conservation of historic monuments. • Created **Imperial Cadet Corps (1901)** under Major D.H. Cameron & Maharaja Pratap Singh of Idar. • **Calcutta Municipal Act, 1899 (Mackenzie Act):** Slashed elected Indian representation. • **Indian Universities Act, 1904** (Raleigh Commission). • Created Department of Commerce and Industry; established Railway Board (1905). • Stated in 1900: *"Congress is tottering to its fall, and one of my great ambitions while in India is to assist it to a peaceful demise."* • **Partition of Bengal (enacted 16 October 1905):** Divided Bengal to break political unity and create communal cleavages; sparked Swadeshi Movement.	Younghusband Expedition to Tibet (1904, Treaty of Lhasa); created North-West Frontier Province (NWFP).	Partition of Bengal & Monument Preservation
Lord Minto II (1905–1910)	Formulated **Morley-Minto Reforms (Indian Councils Act, 1909)**; introduced **separate communal electorates for Muslims** (*Divide and Rule policy*).	S.P. Sinha appointed first Indian to Viceroy's Executive Council; Muslim League founded at Dacca (1906).	Father of Communal Electorate

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Lord Hardinge II (1910–1916)	• Organized **Third Delhi Durbar (December 1911)** for King George V & Queen Mary. • Announced **annulment of Partition of Bengal** and **transfer of imperial capital from Calcutta to Delhi**. • **Delhi Conspiracy Case (23 Dec 1912):** Survived bomb attack by Rash Behari Bose / Anushilan Samiti.	Outbreak of World War I (1914); Mahatma Gandhi returned to India (9 January 1915).	Capital shifted to Delhi
Lord Chelmsford (1916–1921)	Passed Government of India Act 1919 (Diarchy in provinces, bicameral central legislature, Chamber of Princes); Rowlatt Act 1919; Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (13 April 1919).	Non-Cooperation and Khilafat Movements launched (1920).	Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms
Lord Reading (1921–1926)	**Only Jewish Viceroy of India**; Chauri Chaura incident (1922); suspension of Non-Cooperation; Swaraj Party formed (1923); Kakori train action (1925).	Repealed Press Act of 1910 and Rowlatt Act.	Only Jewish Viceroy
Lord Irwin (1926–1931)	Simon Commission (1928); Nehru Report (1928); Lahore Congress Poorna Swaraj resolution (1929); Dandi March & Civil Disobedience (1930); First Round Table Conference (1930); **Gandhi-Irwin Pact (5 March 1931)**.	Deepwater naval expansion & constitutional negotiations.	Gandhi-Irwin Pact
Lord Willingdon (1931–1936)	Second & Third Round Table Conferences; Communal Award & Poona Pact (1932); **Government of India Act, 1935** (Provincial Autonomy).	Severe repression of Civil Disobedience.	Poona Pact & GOI Act 1935
Lord Linlithgow (1936–1943)	Longest continuous tenure (7.5 years); Provincial elections 1937; Congress ministries resigned (Oct 1939); August Offer (1940); Cripps Mission (1942); **Quit India Movement (August 1942)**; Great Bengal Famine (1943).	Longest wartime administration	August Offer & Quit India

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Lord Wavell (1943–1947)	**Wavell Plan & Simla Conference (June–July 1945)**; INA Trials (1945); RIN Mutiny (Feb 1946); **Cabinet Mission (March 1946)**; Direct Action Day (Aug 1946); Interim Government formed (Sept 1946).	Simla Conference & Cabinet Mission	Post-war transition
Lord Mountbatten (March–Aug 1947)	**June 3rd Mountbatten Plan**; Indian Independence Act, 1947; Partition of India into India and Pakistan; **Last Viceroy of British India and First Governor-General of independent Dominion of India**.	Boundary Commissions (Radcliffe Awards); Integration of princely states under Sardar Patel.	Partition & Independence